

XIV. ŠU-IŠTAR (235-245)

The texts published here belonged to or concern men called Šu-Ištar and the question is whether they refer to the same person and if so who he was. Both questions are difficult to answer, because only one text in this chapter mentions the name of his father, Luzinu. If this is a variant of or mistake for Luzina, we could identify him as this well-known trader, who occurs a dozen times as father of Šu-Ištar. In *243 Šu-Ištar, son of Luzinu, features as the owner of two textiles sold by Liptānum to Iddin-Aššur and he probably kept this document about items he owned. The excavation number of this text (Kt 91/k 511) does not link it with the group Kt 91/k 534-551, to which most 'Šu-Ištar texts' presented in this chapter belong and in which Šu-Ištar plays a role as writer or recipient of letters, creditor or party in a conflict.

Šu-Ištar was a popular name and in the Kültepe texts there figure at least forty different Šu-Ištars. The names of their fathers are usually given in legal documents, especially when they are witnesses, but we also have witnesses without patronym (e.g. Šu-Ištar in *199:19, during eponymy year 94). In Elamma's archive we meet - apart from the week eponym Šu-Ištar, son of Aššur-bāni, and Šu-Ištar, the father of the year-eponym Ennam-Suen (REL 115) - six men whose father is called Šu-Ištar and at least five Šu-Ištars with different fathers; the latter are:

son of Dadānum (see below);

son of Ennam-Aššur, *69:24, witness in a debt-note of Elamma;

son of Puzur-Ištar, *113:2 with seal B (that mentions the name of his father), an agreement between him and Elamma, who will send him in Burušhattum tin for which Š. will pay him silver; cf. *106:2, which deals with the same transaction;

son of *Zu-a-a*, *69:36, witness to a debt claim of Elamma;

son of Šuk(k)utum, *10:11//*11:8, witness when silver is entrusted for shipment to Assur.

The first, the son of Dadānum, is the best attested one, also outside our archive. He features in ATHE 1:1, during the year REL 93, and as witness in three undated records of Elamma's archive, *15:3, *110:24 (an agreement involving Elamma), and *202:14. In *3:16 and 22 Elamma is told that this Šu-Ištar, together with Ennam-Aššur, exports (*šēṣu'um*) or bringen (*wabālum*) merchandise to him, obviously from Assur, where he is also in *15:3 (as witness) and in AKT 1, 7:25. His role as transporter is confirmed by TC 3, 26:34, where he will convey messages from Assur to Kanesh, by BIN 4, 13:5-6, where his seals are on a load of merchandise, and by AKT 6, 865:10-11 (courtesy of Larsen), where he conducts textiles to Anatolia. According to VS 26, 47:7-8 he ships silver from Kanesh to Assur, in TC 1, 70:24 he is present there as witness when silver is entrusted for transport, and in CCT 5, 29a:16-17 he is in Hahhum. He was not only a transporter, but also himself a trader and Prag I 750:5-6 mentions a debt-note of his for 12 minas of silver.

We already met a Šu-Ištar in *223, as guarantor of Āl-ṭāb, and in the letters *215-*217 (Ch. XIII) as correspondent of Ennam-Suen. The spelling of these letters, as pointed out in the introduction to them, shows a few scribal peculiarities, which do not return in other 'Šu-Ištar texts'. Šu-Ištar also occurs five times as owner of lots of textiles in the lists presented in Ch. XX (alongside Ennam-Suen, Aššur-rē'ī, and others) and one of them, *121, deals with textiles owned by him and Ennam-Suen. Important is the

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presence in the archive of *151, which lists the expenses of a shipment of merchandise of Šu-Ištar, specified on the basis of its “declared value” (*awītum*; almost 5 talents of tin, equal to probably three or four donkey-loads of tin and textiles), which indicates that it was part of a larger, collective caravan (*ellutum*). It cannot be accidental that *150 is a very similar record about a shipment of Iddin-Suen, who appears alongside Šu-Ištar in several of the textile lists. Something similar may well be the background of *126, according to which “we – I, Kura and Šu-Ištar – came together and gave account (*awātam tadānum*) to Pīlah-Ištar, son of Uzua, because of the losses”, presumably suffered by such a caravan. It is not unlikely, though difficult to prove, that the texts of the present chapter concern this Šu-Ištar

Texts of Šu-Ištar in this chapter shed light on his commercial activities and contacts. Some record debt claims of his, which he would have carefully kept: *241 is a copy of a debt-note for silver due from Ikūnum, with an added memo on various other debt claims (in all for ca. 110 shekels of silver); *242 a contract for a silver debt (amount missing) due by Ilī-ālum, with an agreement on its payment. Text *243 is a deposition dealing with textiles that belonged to him, and *244 one by witnesses concerning a private summons, whereby Šu-Ištar tried to collect a debt of 4 shekels of gold owed by Puzur-Aššur, son of Itur-ilī. *235 and *236 are letters of Šu-Ištar to his representatives Puzur-Aššur and Ikuppi-Aššur about an overdue debt of 3 minas of silver owed by a certain Idnāya; *237 he wrote to Kudādum and two Anatolians. These letters must be archive copies or they were later returned to him by the addressees. Of the letters addressed to him *238 (by three men) deals with a large number of textiles packed in bags, which he “left in the house of Galua”; *239 deals with a possible debt to Iliš-tikal and *240 with the sale of wool and a silver loan. In the transactions mentioned in *238 and *240 Pūšu-kēn is somehow involved and *240:14 mentions an agreement between Šu-Ištar and Ir’am-Aššur.

Because it seems rather likely that tablets with consecutive excavation numbers belonged to one group or file, a few more tablets with numbers between Kt 91/k 534-551 may have belonged to Šu-Ištar, although this is difficult to prove from their content. In the letter *273 (Kt 91/545) the name of the addressee is missing, *338 (Kt 91/548) is an anonymous memo in the first person singular, while *299 (Kt 91/k 535) records a debt owed to “the creditor”. This group also comprises some completely isolated tablets, such as *271 (Kt 91/k 539), a letter from Abduata to Unapše, *263 (Kt 91/k 543) an isolated letter from Šat-Tašmētim, *267 (Kt 91/k 547) a letter(?) by Šamaš-bāni, and *268 (Kt 91/k 550) a letter by Puzur-Ana and Aššur-rabi to Šu-Bēlum. Since it is better to keep separate what cannot be proved to belong together, I did not include these last texts in this chapter. The just-mentioned four letters figure among the “Letters from and to various persons” of Ch. XVI; the other texts find their place in Chs. XIX and XXI.

A. Letters

Letters by Šu-Ištar

235. Kt 91/k 551 (1-404-91)

A letter by Šu-Ištar to Puzur-Aššur and Ikūn-pī-Aššur, his representatives, and in particular to Idnāya, who owes Šu-Ištar a debt of silver, whose payment is three months overdue.

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	<i>a-na Puzur₄-A-šur</i>	Say to Puzur-Aššur,
	<i>Id-na-a ù l-^oku-pí₂-/A-šur</i>	Idnaya and Ikūn-pī-Aššur
	<i>qí-bi-ma um-ma</i>	thus Šu-Ištar,
	<i>Šu-Ištar-ma a-na Id-na-/a</i>	say (in particular) to Idnāya:
5	<i>qí-bi₄-ma 3 ma-na</i>	“3 minas of
	KÙ.B. <i>ša-ru-pá-am</i>	refined silver
	<i>ha-bu-lá-at</i>	you owe (me),
	<i>u₄-mu-kà</i>	your term is
l.e.	<i>12 ha-am-ša-tim</i>	12 weeks
rev.	<i>e-tí-qú a-hi a-ta</i>	overdue. Please, my brother,
11	KÙ.B. <i>ú ši-ba-sú šu-qú-ul-/ma</i>	pay the silver and its interest
	<i>a-na té-er-tí-a</i>	and let them give it to
	<i>li-dí-nu</i> (erasure)	where I will instruct’.
	<i>a-na ša ki-ma i-a-tí</i>	Say to my representatives:
15	<i>qí-bi₄-ma i-hi-da-ma</i>	‘Take care to
	KÙ.B. <i>ú ši-ba-sú</i>	to make him pay
u.e.	<i>ša-áš-qí-lá-šu-ma</i>	the silver and the interest on it
	<i>a-na té-er-tí-a</i>	and forward it to where
le.e.	<i>pá-ni-a</i>	I will instruct’.”

Notes

18-19. Kouwenberg refers me to an other occurrence of *ana te’erti* PN *pannu’um*, in BIN 6, 95: rev.2’-6’, *kaspum ana šērika lillikamma ana te’ertika pannišuma ina hubullia lišheram*, “let the silver (from the sale of merchandise) come to you and transfer it to where you have been instructed and let it be deducted from my debt”. I assume that pron. suffix added to *te’ertum* (also in l. 12) can refer to the person who gave or who received the instruction.

236. Kt 91/k 536 (1-389-91)

A letter to his representatives (see *235:14) about the debt of Idnāya, also the subject of *235.

	<i>a-na Puzur₄-A-šur</i>	Say to Puzur-Aššur
	<i>ú l-ku-pi-A-šur</i>	and Ikūn-pī-Aššur,
	<i>qí-bi₄-ma um-ma Šu-Ištar-ma</i>	thus Šu-Ištar:
	<i>be-lu-ú-a a-tù-nu</i>	“Please, my lords,
5	<i>i-hi-da-ma</i>	take care to make
	KÙ.B. <i>ú ši-ba-sú-ú</i>	Idnāya pay the silver
	<i>Id-na-<a> ša-áš-qí-lá</i>	and the interest on it.
	<i>a-le-e</i> KÙ.B. <i>[Id-na-a]</i>	Consider where silver of
	<i>10 GÍN e-li-a-[ni]</i>	Idnāya, if only 10 shekels,
rev.	<i>mī-li-ik šu-m[a]</i>	may turn up. If
11	<i>a-wi-lu-um</i>	the man indeed
	KÙ.B. <i>i-šu-ú</i>	has silver, then
	^d UTU- <i>ba-ni na-hi-da-ma</i>	warn Šamaš-bāni that
	<i>a-na ma-e</i>	he must not allow
15	<i>ša-tá-e-em</i>	him to drink

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	<i>lá ú-ša-ar-šu</i>	water, (saying):
	KÙ.B.- <i>pu-um</i> KÙ.B.- <i>áp-kà</i>	'The silver is your silver!'
	<i>a-wi-lu-um la-mu-un</i>	The man is a crook,
u.e.	<i>e ú-ni-ku-nu-ma ih-/da</i>	let him not cheat you!
20	KÙ.B <i>ú ší-ba-sú</i>	Take care to make him pay
	<i>ša-áš-qí-lá</i>	the silver and the interest on it!"

Notes

12. Šamaš-bāni also appears in *240:3 as one of three men who write a letter to Šu-Ištar about financial matters.

14-15. The expression "to let somebody drink water" could mean something like "do not give him respite", but it may well be an abbreviation of *ma'ē šatā'um ina šēr* PN, "to drink water at somebody's expense", "to profit from somebody", which is attested in BIN 4, 29:44 and Kayseri 293:20-22.

17. Since the addressees are referred to by the plural (l. 19), I assume that l. 17 had to be said to Šamaš-bāni.

Comment

Idnāya might be identical to the man who occurs as debtor of Elamma in *55:3//*74:6-7//*75:5-6 (from eponymy year 81) and *70:29 for some minas of silver, in *119 settles accounts with him, and in whose caravan Elamma had a share according to *72:4-5. Šu-Ištar's polite, but unsuccessful letter to his representatives and Idnāya, *235, must have been followed by the severe letter *236 to his representatives alone. How the affair ended remains unknown.

237. Kt 91/k 549 (1-402-91)

A letter by Šu-Ištar to three men (two of them have non-Assyrian names) about the expected arrival of small amounts of silver, about the destination of a wagon load of straw, and about two silver debts, presumably owed by Anatolians.

	<i>[um-m]a Šu-Ištar-m[a]</i>	Thus Šu-Ištar, say to
	<i>a-na Ku-da-dim Hu-ma-da-šu ù</i>	to Kudādum, Humadašu and
	<i>A-ba-mu-li qí-bi₄-ma</i>	Abamuli:
	4 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>a-na Ku-da-dim</i>	"4 shekels of silver for Kudādum,
5	2 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>a-na Nu-hu-ša-tim</i>	2 shekels of silver for Nuhušatum,
	<i>a-ha-ma</i> 5 GÍN KÙ.B.	(and) separately 5 shekels of silver
	<i>Ku-ra na-áš-<a>-ku-nu-tí</i>	Kura is bringing you ^{plur} .
	<i>iš-té-et : i-re-qám</i>	One wagon load
	<i>ša tí-ib-nim</i>	of straw I left
10	<i>i-[na] Kà-n[i-/iš]*</i>	behind
l.e.	*x [?] <i>e-zi-ib</i>	in Kanesh.
rev.	<i>li-qí-a-ma</i>	Take it and
	<i>li-ib-ší-a</i>	let it remain available.
	15 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>Hu-li</i>	Make Huli pay 15 shekels of
15	<i>ša-áš-qí-lá-šu-ma ša ½ ma-na</i>	silver and draw up a debt-note
	<i>ṭup-pu-šu lu-up-ta ½ GÍN</i>	of his for ½ mina. Dudu, son
	<i>Du-du DUMU A-šur-DÙG</i>	of Aššur-ṭāb, owes me ½ shekel
	<i>ha-bu-lam šu-ma wa-ša-/áb</i>	of silver; if he is staying there
	KÙ.B. <i>ša-áš-qí-lá-šu</i>	make him pay the silver.

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- 20 *ṭup-pu-šu i-na ta-ma-/lá-kà-[x]* His debt-note is in the
ša i-ku-nu-ke tablet box that is sealed
ša Ša-lim-ma kà-an-/ku with the seals of
i-ba-ší Šalimma.”

Notes

5. The name of this woman is usually spelled Nuhšatum and she is the wife of Ennum-Aššur, known from the Kt v/k archive published in AKT 3 (cf. 104:3). Two letters addressed to her by her husband and found in 1991, as their numbers (Kt 91/k 562 and 563) show, did not belong to Elamma's archive and are published separately by me in Veenhof 2014c.

13. *Libšia* is a mistake (suggested by *liqiā?*) for *libšiam*, “let it be available to me”, or for *libši*.

17. This Dudu also occurs in Kt 91/k 132:3 and 200:17.

20-24. The last word of l. 20 probably is a mistake for *tamalakkim* or *tamalakkika*. Šalimma is known from the archive (see Ch. XII) as wife of Ir'am-Aššur (*207:1') and as owner of a house, bought from Ištar-lamassī and Aššur-ṭāb (*210). In her letter *208 she asks Aššur-imittī to take out of her tablet-box(es) a debt-note of Ilī-bāni, which Šu-Ištar then has to bring her. The information in our letter enables the addressees to return his debt-note to Huli upon payment.

Letters to Šu-Ištar

238. Kt 91/k 540 (1-393-91)

A letter in a rather coarse script, whose upper edge has been damaged, by three men who react to instructions Šu-Ištar had sent them about an important shipment of textiles, left behind by him in leather bags, under his seals in the house of Galua. In accordance with Pūšu-kēn's written instruction they entrusted about half of them to a certain Huna, while the other half is still in Galua's house.

- | | |
|--|---|
| <p><i>um-ma °A²-mur² -lu²-sú-/ma*</i>
 <i>Šu-li ù GE₆-li-Ištar</i>
 <i>a-na Šu-Ištar qí-bi₄-ma</i>
 <i>ta-áš-pu-ra-am</i>
 5 <i>um-ma a-ta-ma 15 na-ru-/qá-tim</i>
 <i>ku-nu-ki-a : É Ga-lu-a</i>
 <i>e-zi-ib ṭup-pá-am</i>
 <i>ša Pu-šu-ki-in</i>
 <i>am-ra-ma : ma-lá</i>
 10 <i>té-er-tim ša Pu-šu-/ki-in</i>
 <i>ep-ša i-na DUB-pi-im</i>
 l.e. <i>ša Pu-šu-ki-in</i>
 rev. <i>1 me-at 30 TÚG.HI.A</i>
 <i>lá-áp-tu(m)</i>
 15 <i>na-ru-qá-tim</i>
 <i>nu-ma-hi-ir-ma</i>
 <i>1 me-at 16 TÚG.HI.A</i>
 <i>60 TÚG.HI.A 10 na-ru-/qá-/tim</i></p> | <p>Thus Amur²-(i)lūssu,
 Šuli and Šilli-Ištar,
 say to Šu-Ištar:
 “You wrote us as follows:
 ‘15 bags under my
 seals I left in Galua's
 house. Inspect the
 tablet of Pūšu-kēn and
 act in accordance with
 Pūšu-kēn's instruction’.
 In the tablet of
 Pūšu-kēn
 130 textiles
 are written,
 but when we took delivery
 of the bags there were
 (only) 116 textiles!
 60² textiles (in) 10 bags</p> |
|--|---|

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	<i>a-na Hu-na * ú-ri-du</i>	went down to Huna,
20	IGI A-šur-ta-ak-/lá-ku	in the presence of
	IGI MAR.TU-ba-ni	Aššur-taklāku,
	IGI En-na-A-šur	of Amurru-bāni,
	<i>ni-ip-qí-id</i>	of Ennam-Aššur.
u.e.	56 [?] TÚG* S[IG ₅] [?]	56 textiles of good quality
25	x* ta-tim	
le.e	É Ga-lu-a*: i-ba-ší-ú	are still in Galua's house."

Notes

1. Due to damage of the upper edge the reading of the first name is uncertain, also because the third sign, without inner vertical, looks more like KU.

6. Without patronym the identity of G/Kalua is unknown; there are several men of that name in the 'Kultepe texts', one is an Anatolian *rabi mahīrim* (see *OBO* 160/5, 221).

10-12. The nature of Pūšu-kēn's instruction and the basis for his discretion are unknown, but he must have had certain rights on the textiles, said to be sealed and not owned by Šu-Ištar. Pūšu-kēn also figures in letter *240:9-10, whose writers tell Šu-Ištar that part of the yield of the sale of wool will be sent to Pūšu-kēn.

14. *Laptum* hypercorrect for *laptū*, see *Grammar* § 2.5 and in this volume *264:11, *i-bi₄-tum*.

15-18. Textiles were packed in leather bags, see *23:6 and *AOATT* 38f., (which quotes the informative text LB 1269), which usually contained 5 or 6 pieces, as in *166:4-5, in Kt 91/k 106 (good quality textiles packed [*darkū*] in 4 bags in lots of 4 to 6 pieces), and in l. 18 of our text, but occasionally more, up to 12 and 15 pieces, presumably depending the size of the bag and the quality of the textiles. The 15 bags of l. 5+17 of our text each would have contained 7 or 8 textiles.

16. The D-stem of *mahārum* (the second sign is a clear MA, with a small first vertical), because of the plural object(?), is unique; Kouwenberg considers an emendation to *nu-pā¹-hi-ir*, "we collected" possible.

19. The verb can only be *warādum* and *urdū* > *uridū*, with vowel epenthesis seems more likely than **urridū*, since the verb does not occur in the D-stem. The verb suggests that Huna is an (otherwise unknown) place-name.

239. Kt 91/k 541 (1-394-91)

A friendly letter to Šu-Ištar by Iliš-tikal explaining why he did not meet him. The promise to pay him the triple (*šušalšum*) of a possible debt amounts to a denial that he owes him anything.

	[a]-na Šu-Ištar	To Šu-Ištar
	[q]í-bi ₄ -ma um-ma	speak, this is what
	l-[l]í-iš-tí-kál-ma	Iliš-tikal says:
	ki-ma ša-nu-a-tí-ni	"Since you were elsewhere
5	lá °a ₂ -tù-ra-[am]	I did not come back.
	šu-ma	Should I
rev.	mì-ma	owe you
	ha-bu-lá-ku-u[m]	anything,
	šu-šál-šu-um	I will pay (it)
10	lá-áš-qú-ul	threefold."
	IGI (erasure)	

Notes

4. *Šanā'um*, “to become different”, in OA is used in the G-stem with *libbum*, *ṭēmum* and *harrānum* as subjects and in the D-stem with *libbum* as object (CCT 4, 36a:33; KTK 18:4). The stative here, with *libbum* as implied object, could mean “you have changed your plans” or, without *libbum*, “you are elsewhere”. It occurs in the stative of the D-stem in CCT 1, 49b:5 // KUG 15 + AO 29196: 7 and 21, *lā libbi ilim* PN *ša-nu* “unfortunately PN is.....”, said of Sueyya, who has disappeared, cf. *EL* II p. 163 note a and 164 note c.

9. Payment of “the triple” (*šušalšum*) of a debt is usually contracted (*rakkusum*, the result is a contract, *tarkistum*) and accepted by a creditor or debtor, who imposes or rejects a debt claim without being able to present evidence for it. Triple payment is such a heavy fine, that the one who accepts it can be trusted to speak the truth (see now *OALP* 260).

240. Kt 91/k 534 (1-387-91)

In this letter, whose rev. and left edge have suffered damage, three men in reaction to a letter of Šu-Ištar report that when Anatolians arrive to deliver wool (which Šu-Ištar had bought some-where?) they will sell it, divide its yield and send Pūšu-kēn what he is entitled to(?).

1	[a-n]a Šu-Ištar qí-bi-ma um-ma Zu-ba Ma-ta-ga-x* ú ^d UTU-ba-ni-ma a-šu-mi ša-áp-tim ša ta-áš-pu-ra-/ni	Say to Šu-Ištar, thus Zuba, Mataga-x and Šamaš-bāni: “As for the wool about which you wrote,
5	eṭ-lu-tum i-ma-qú-tù-/ni-ma ša-áp-tám iš-té-ni-/iš ₆ (IS) ni-dá-an-ma KÙ.B. ni-zu-wa-az _x (ÁŠ) : *KI iš-°x/ x (x) _z a-na Pu-šu-ki-/in	when the men arrive here we will sell all the wool together and we will divide the silver and we will send it to
10	nu-šé-ba-lam a-šu-mi É ^{be-et} DAM.<GÀR>-ri-im	Pūšu-kēn. As for calling at a merchant's house (for a loan),
rev.	ša _x (ZA)-sà-im : qá-áb-a-tí-/ni a-na-kam iš-tí Ir-ma-A-šur a-ta-am-ga-/ar	as you have promised, I have here now come to an agreement with Ir'am-Aššur and he said:
15	um-ma šu-ut-ma té-er-/tù-šu [a-š]é-er I-ku-pi-/A-šur [ú]-a-tí li-li-/kam-ma [la-d]i-na-ku-ma [x x] *x ki-ma ak-lá-/ku-kà-ni	'Let his instruction come to Ikūn-pī-Aššur and to me, then I will give it to you'. since I have <i>exploited</i> you
20	[x x x x] gí ₅ -im-/lá-ni [.....]	 do me a favor
u.e.	[x x x x] _z * ša Ma-ma-a [(x) da-mi] [?] -iq-tám a-na x *ša-áp-tám [x x x a _z -na ší-tí	[..... wool [?]] of Mamma the wool for the rest of
25	[x x x] šé-bi ₄ -lam	 send to me.”

Notes

The writer was not a trained scribe, as shown by the wrong use of GIŠ for iš in l. 6, ÁŠ for az in l. 8, and ZA for ša in l. 12. The construction of lines 10-12 is also strange, since one expects either *aššumi* (as preposition) ... *šasā'im ša qab'ātini*, or *aššumi* (as conjunction) ... *šasa'am qab'ātini*. The form at the end of l. 19 is perhaps a mistake for **taklāku-ka-ni*, "since I trust in you", which suits as introduction to *gimlanni*.

8. End of line unclear, it could be KI = *išti*, "(to send) with", in which case KI ILLAT, "with the caravan", would make sense, but the last, indented sign does not look like ILLAT. A reading *kišdātišu*, "what he is entitled to", makes sense, but seems impossible.

11-13. See Veenhof 1999, 67. The meaning of the stative of *qabā'um* can be active and passive.

14-17. The subject of the verb probably is Šamaš-bāni, whom Šu-Ištar's representatives (among them Ikuppi-Aššur) have to warn in *236:13.

18. The object of the verb is not clear, either the instruction or the loan to be taken out.

19. The tablet is clear (x* is either *[š]a* or *[t]a*) and the form can only be derived from *akālum*, "(since) I have (already) consumed you" (although a personal accusative suffix added to a stative is weird). If so, the verb must be used metaphorically, "I have exploited you", "profited from you". A desperate alternative is a very garbled "I trust in you" (*taklāku*) + acc. suffix

22. Suggested by TC 3, 65:18-21, *šaptam ša Mamma naribtam araktam damiqtam ūtartam*.

B. Legal documents

241. Kt 91/k 542 (1-395-91)

A short memo that records the existence of various debt claims of Šu-Ištar, the first probably the excerpt of a debt-note, the other a simple list of what is owed by (*ina libbi*) various persons.

	1 ma-na 10 GÍN	1 mina and 10 shekels
	KÙ.B. <i>ša-ru-pá-am</i>	of refined silver
	<i>i-li-bi₄ I-ku-nu</i>	are owed by Ikūnu(m)
	<i>Šu-Ištar i-šu</i>	to Šu-Ištar,
5	IGI A-da-da DUB.SAR	witnessed by Adada, the scribe,
	IGI <i>Im-li-kà-a</i>	and by Imlikaya.
	1 TÚG <i>ku-sí-<<a>>-tám</i>	1 <i>kusītu</i> -textile,
rev.	<i>a-ha-ma</i>	separately,
	<i>e-zi-ib-šu-ma</i>	I left to him and
10	7½ GÍN KÙ.B.	7½ shekels of silver
	<i>i-li-bi₄</i>	are owed (for it?) by
	<i>I-dí-Da-ga-°a_n</i>	Iddin-Dagan.
	5 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>i-li-/bi₄</i>	5 shekels of silver owed
	<i>A-šur²-[m]a-lik</i>	by Aššur-mālik,
15	⅓ ma-na 8 GÍN	28 shekels of
	AN.NA <i>i-li-bi₄</i>	tin owed by
u.e.	<i>Puzur₄-A-šur</i>	Puzur-Aššur.

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Notes

5. The scribe Adada, son of Adad-rabi (also a scribe, cf. CCT 1, 8a:3 and Kt m/k 76:3f.), who also took part in the trade (see AKT 3, 27:20-21; 28:10-12), is very well-known and occurs more than twenty times in the Kültepe texts. His seal was perhaps CS 1208, impressed as seal C on *64.

242. Kt 91/k 544 (1-397-91)

A small, worn tablet that quotes a debt-note, with added clauses stating how the creditor will get back his money, even by borrowing from a money-lender a possible rest of the debt.

	[x <i>ma-na</i>] 2 GÍN	[x minas and] 2 shekels
	KÙ.B. [<i>ša-r</i>] <i>u-pá-am</i>	of refined silver
	<i>i-še-er Ì-lí-a-lim</i>	Ilī-ālum owes
	<i>Šu-Ištar i-šu</i>	to Šu-Ištar.
5	[I]GI <i>Ì-lí-dan</i>	Witnessed by Ilī-dān,
	[D]UMU <i>Id-na-A-šur</i>	son of Id(di)n-Aššur,
	IGI <i>I-ku-pí-A-šur</i>	by Ikūn-pī-Aššur,
	DUMU <i>Puzur₄-lš-/tár</i>	son of Puzur-Ištar,
i.e.	IGI <i>Šu-ku-[bi-im]</i>	and by Šu-Kū[bum].
10	<i>i-na °x-x x₂* lu iš-tù Ku-bu-ur-/na-at</i>	On he will send it me from
	[<i>ū</i>]- <i>še-ba-lam</i>	Kuburnat or I will
	[<i>lu</i>] <i>i-na ba-a-áb-tí-šu</i>	take it from his outstanding
	<i>a-lá-qé ší-tí KÙ.B.</i>	claims. The rest of the silver
15	<i>a-na ší-ib-tim</i>	I will (then) borrow at
	<i>a-la-qé-ma KÙ.B.</i>	interest and the silver
	<i>ù ší-ba-sú</i>	and the interest on it
	<i>Ì-lí-a-lim</i>	Ilī-ālum
	[<i>ú-m</i>] <i>a¹-lá</i>	will compensate.

Notes

19. The restoration is suggested by similar provisions in some debt-notes, e.g. in RA 59 (1959) 21, no.3:8-11. See for the procedure of borrowing at a defaulting debtor's expense and the occurrence of clauses in the first person singular in such cases, Veenhof 1999, 66-69.

243. Kt 91/k 511 (1-364-91)

Undated protocol of a testimony rendered before the Wahšušana colony by one of the two witnesses, who had been present at a commercial transaction involving textiles belonging to Šu-Ištar, which apparently had later caused a problem.

2 TÚG.HI.A <i>ku-ta-ni</i>	Two <i>kutānu</i> -textiles belonging
<i>ša Šu-Ištar DUMU Lu-zi-ni</i>	to Šu-Ištar, son of Luzinu,
<i>a-na 27 ma-na URUDU</i>	Liptānum gave to
<i>ma-sí-im Li-ip-ta-/num</i>	Iddin-Aššur, son of

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5	<i>a-na l-dí-A-šùr</i> DUMU <i>Dan-A-šùr i-dí-in</i> <i>a-na a-wa-tim</i> <i>a-ni-a-tim</i> <i>kà-ru-um Wa-ah-šu-ša-/na</i>	Dān-Aššur, for 27 minas of refined copper. For this affair the Wahšušana colony made
10	<i>i-dí-ni-ma</i>	me available and
u.e.	IGI <i>šu-ga-ri-a-im</i>	before the š.-symbol
rev.	<i>ša A-šùr ší-bu-tí</i> <i>a-dí-in IGI Bu-za-zu</i> DUMU <i>Pu-šu-ki-in</i>	of Aššur I gave my testimony. In the presence of Buzāzu, son of Pūšu-kēn.
15	<i>A-šùr-du-ri DUMU</i> <i>Puzur₄-lštar tap-pá-i</i>	Aššur-dūrī, son of Puzur-lštar was my fellow witness.

Notes

2. See the introduction to this chapter on the possible identity of Luzinu and Luzina.

5-6. This man also appears in Kt 91/k 141:21-22, as debtor (without date).

6. *Iddin* here probably means handing over on consignment. The reason for the problem may have been that the transaction was carried out not by the owner of the textiles himself, so that it required a later settlement of accounts.

15. This witness is attested in two undated records (both courtesy of J.G. Dercksen): Kt a/k 440:41, a deposition made before the Wahšušana colony, and Kt a/k 403:21-22//513:18, on a confrontation involving Buzāzu and Adad-šulūlī before the trading station of Kuburnat. The same man must also be meant in *348:10. Aššur-dūrī occurs without filiation in texts dated to the years REL 97-104. He, or an earlier namesake, features in *70:25//*74:16//*75:10 as debtor of Elamma during eponymy year REL 67, and without a date in *69:30.

Comment

The transfer (sale or consignment) of the textiles was witnessed by two men, but when some time later a testimony was required, because problems had arisen (probably due to the fact that a middleman had been involved), only one of them, Buzāzu, was available to testify.

244. Kt 91/k 546 (1-399-91)

Record with the testimony by two witnesses, “seized” by Šu-lštar, to confirm that he had told Puzur-Aššur that he owed him a small debt in gold and that Puzur-Aššur had acknowledged this and promised payment. The end mentions that two court witnesses heard their testimony given under oath and also available in writing (l. 18, “their tablet”). They must have sealed the now missing envelope that contained this deposition to guarantee its correctness.

5	<i>Šu-lštar a-[na]</i> <i>Puzur₄-A-š[ùr]</i> DUMU <i>l-tù-u[r-DINGIR]</i> <i>iš-ba-at-ni-[a-tí-ma]</i> <i>um-ma Šu-lštar-ma</i> <i>a-na Puzur₂-A-šùr-ma</i> 4 GÍN KÙ.GI	Šu-lštar seized us against Puzur-Aššur, the son of Itūr-ilī, and Šu-lštar said to Puzur-Aššur: “You owe
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	<i>ša Ša-at-A-šūr</i>	4 shekels of gold,
	<i>ha-bu-lá-/tí-ni</i>	belonging to Šat-Aššur,
rev.	SIG ₅ DIRIG	it was of very good quality!"
11	<i>um-ma Puzur₂-A-šūr-ma</i>	Puzur-Aššur answered:
	<i>ke-na ha-bu-lá-ku</i>	"Indeed, I owe it,
	<i>a-ša-qal</i>	I will pay it."
	<i>Ší-lu-lu ù</i>	Šilulu and
15	<i>Da-da-a DUMU</i>	Dadaya, son of
	<i>*Ub²-ra-e-im</i>	the man from Ubra ² .
	<i>IGI šu-ga-ri-a-[m]</i>	gave their ta[blet]
u.e	<i>ša A-šūr DU[B-pu-šu-nu]</i>	before the š.-emblem
	<i>i-d[í-nu]</i>	of Aššur.
20	<i>Šu-[]</i>	Šu-[],
le.e	<i>DUMU I-<zi>-za-am-i-lí:</i>	son of Izizam-ilī
	<i>ù A-bi₄-a DUMU A-^ota₂ -a</i>	and Abiya, son of Ataya,
	<i>pá-šu-nu iš-me-ú</i>	heard their statement.

Notes

2-3. This man occurs also in Kt a/k 900a:4, from eponymy year REL 88.

9. Since this cannot mean "which Š. owes", the final *-ni* of *habbulātini* must be wrong (was the scribe misled by the preceding *ša?*), unless we take it to mean "which you owe *me*", as Kouwenberg tentatively suggests (cf. *Grammar* § 16.13 with note 730).

16. Reading of the first sign uncertain; the word must be a nisbe.

20-24. See for this type of records, sworn *testimonia* given by witnesses of a private summons, Veenhof 1991, 457f., and also the text of the bulla Kt n/k 1708 (Özgüç – Tunca 2001, 326).

22. This man also occurs in Kt 91/k 211:16, from eponymy year REL 98.

245. Kt 92/k 122 (1-84-92)

Small black tablet with a witnessed record of the seizure by Bēlum-rabi of a small amount of silver belonging to Šu-Ištar.

	<i>4½ GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	4½ shekels of silver,
	<i>ša Šu-Ištar</i>	belonging to Šu-Ištar,
	<i>Be-lum-ra-bi₄</i>	Bēlum-rabi
	<i>iš-ba-at</i>	seized.
5	<i>um-ma Be-lum-ra-/bi₄-ma</i>	Bēlum-rabi declared:
rev.	<i>a-na a-wa-at</i>	"I take the responsibility
	<i>Šu-Ištar ma-ša-ku</i>	vis-à-vis Šu-Ištar."
	<i>IGI En-na-Sú-/in</i>	Before Ennam-Suen,
	<i>IGI Puzur₄-l</i>	before Puzur-.....,
10	<i>lá-ah</i>	
	<i>IGI Ku-ra</i>	before Kura.

Notes

3. This name is very rare, in Kt 86/k 167:4 (which mentions him as recipient of a *be'ulātu*-loan) it is written ^d*Be-lum-ra-bí*, which shows that it refers to the god Bēlum.

9-10. Writing clear, meaning unclear.

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Comment

This record must have been drawn up for Šu-Ištar when Bēlum-rabi seized silver belonging to Šu-Ištar in the latter's absence, presumably because he had a claim on him. He assumes responsibility for his action.